

- ◆ Unit 3: International Business – *Section A* and *Section B*
- ◆ Unit 4a: Making Business Decisions and Unit 4b: The Wider Economic Environment and Business – *Section B*.

Assessment objectives and weighting

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
A01	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specified content.	30%	20%	25%
A02	Apply knowledge and understanding of the specified content to problems and issues arising from both familiar and unfamiliar situations.	30%	20%	25%
A03	Analyse problems, issues and situations.	20%	30%	25%
A04	Evaluate, distinguish between and assess appropriateness of fact and opinion, and judge information from a variety of sources.	20%	30%	25%
TOTAL		100%	100%	100%

Synoptic assessment

In synoptic assessment there should be a concentration on the quality of assessment to ensure that it encourages the development of the holistic understanding of the subject.

Synopticity requires students to connect knowledge, understanding and skills acquired in different parts of the Advanced GCE course.

Synoptic assessment in Advanced GCE Business will be met through Unit 3: International Business and Unit 4a: Making Business Decisions and in Advanced GCE Economics and Business through Unit 3: International Business and Unit 4b: The Wider Economic Environment and Business. In Unit 3 students are required to draw on their knowledge of how a business operates and apply it to an overseas context. Units 4a and 4b will be assessed via a decision-making report designed to test the ability of students to think at a higher strategic level to address complex issues and problems. The context of the decision-making report will be pre-released on www.edexcel.org.uk.

Stretch and challenge

Students can be stretched and challenged in A2 units through the use of different assessment strategies, for example:

- using a variety of stems in questions – such as, explain, examine, assess, compare, provide the case for and against, justify, analyse, evaluate
- ensuring connectivity between sections of questions – for example through use of data response questions where answers are applied to the supplied context
- a requirement for extended writing in Units 3, 4a and 4b
- use of a wider range of question types to address different skills — for example open-ended questions, case studies, decision-making report etc
- use of supplied data to enable students to make deductions that support answers.

Additional information

Malpractice and plagiarism

For up-to-date advice on malpractice and plagiarism, please refer to the *Joint Council for Qualifications — Suspected Malpractice in Examinations: Policies and Procedures* document on the JCQ website <http://www.jcq.org.uk/>

**Access
arrangements
and special
requirements**

Edexcel's policy on access arrangements and special considerations for GCE, GCSE, and Entry Level aims to enhance access to the qualifications for learners with disabilities and other difficulties (as defined by the Disability Discrimination Act 1995 and the amendments to the Act) without compromising the assessment of skills, knowledge, understanding or competence.

Please see the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.org.uk/sfc) for:

- the JCQ policy Access Arrangements and Special Considerations, Regulations and Guidance Relating to Candidates who are Eligible for Adjustments in Examinations.
- the forms to submit for requests for access arrangements and special considerations
- dates for submission of the forms.

Requests for access arrangements and special considerations must be addressed to:

Special Requirements
Edexcel
One90 High Holborn
London
WC1V 7BH

**Disability
Discrimination Act**

Please see *Appendix 7* for Advanced GCE in Business Studies and Economics and Business Disability Discrimination Act information.

Prior learning and progression**Prior learning**

There are no prior knowledge requirements for this qualification. The specification builds on, but does not depend upon, students having followed a course in GCSE Business, GCSE Economics or GCSE Business and Economics.

Progression

The qualification provides a solid foundation for studies at a higher level in the following subject areas: business management, business administration, accountancy and finance, human resource management, marketing, retail management, tourism management and international business.

The qualification may also lead on to a career in the commercial world, for example in banking, sales, product management or general management. Business and management skills are also considered desirable skills to have in public sector organisations or charities.

Combinations of entry**Forbidden combinations are:**

- Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics and Business and Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics.
- Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics and Business and Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Business Studies.

Student recruitment

Edexcel's access policy concerning recruitment to our qualifications is that:

- they must be available to anyone who is capable of reaching the required standard.
- they must be free from barriers that restrict access and progression.
- equal opportunities exist for all students.

Key skills

This qualification provides opportunities for developing and generating evidence for assessing the key skills listed below:

- application of number
- communication
- information and communication technology
- improving own learning and performance
- problem solving
- working with others.

Further details are available in *Appendices 2 and 3*.

This qualification will be mapped to functional skills once they are finalised. Information will be available on our website (www.edexcel.org.uk/gce2008) at a later date.

The wider curriculum

This qualification provides opportunities for developing an understanding of spiritual, moral, ethical, social and cultural issues, together with an awareness of citizenship, environmental issues, health and safety considerations, and European developments consistent with relevant international agreements appropriate as applied to Business and Economics and Business. *Appendix 4: Wider curriculum* maps the opportunities available.